

7 EARLY MARRIAGE SYMPTOMS

Next I'd like to discuss the differences between symptoms and problems. Many young couples suffer financial symptoms, but remember that the symptom is only what you see on the outside. If you deal only with what you see, the problem will crop up somewhere else. You must deal with the source to correct the problem.

Why do people want to deal with symptoms rather than problems? Because relieving the symptom provides fast, temporary peace. Unfortunately, when the next symptom appears, it is usually worse than the previous one and more difficult to deal with.

Let's look at some escape mechanisms many husbands and wives use in a futile attempt to ease the pain of financial troubles:

AVOIDING REALITY

One way to relieve tension temporarily is to pretend that no problem exists. Most people who avoid reality simply seek to postpone the inevitable.

Businessmen have been known to manipulate every conceivable angle in an attempt to prolong the life of a hopeless business even one more day. Had they been asked to counsel another businessman in a similar situation, often they would have advised him to shut down and liquidate much earlier.

Why do people refuse to face the reality of a situation sooner? The answer is they hope that some miracle will reverse the situation and bail them out.

I believe in miracles. But I have observed that God does not violate His scriptural principles to accomplish His goals; He always follows His own rules.

LITTLE WHITE LIES

A common symptom is for one spouse to lie to the other about their financial situation just as the attorney, Drew, did in our earlier example. It may be an effort to ignore the problems, or